8. The purpose of a coalition adjustment is to seize power.

In our country, we have seen coalitions coming up either before the elections or after the elections. The pre-poll coalition is considerably advantageous because it provides a common platform to the parties in order to woo the electorate on the basis of a joint manifesto. The post-election union is intended to enable constituents to share political power and run the government[6].

FORMATION

In the first four Lok Sabha elections (1952, 1957, 1962 and 1967), the Congress party secured the required majority to form the government at the Centre. Even though there was a split in the Congress party in 1969, the minority government of Indira Gandhi managed to continue with the outside support of the CPI, the DMK and other parties. Again, the Congress party won the 1971 elections and formed a single-party government.

However, the dominant Congress party was badly defeated in the 1977 elections. Since then, there have been a number of coalition governments at the Centre. The details are mentioned in Table 85.1.

Table 85.1 Formation of Coalition Governments at the Centre

Sl. No.	Period	Coalition	Prime Minister (Party)	Partners
1.	1977–1979	Janata Party	Morarji Desai (Congress (O))	Congress (O), Bharatiya Jana Sangh, Bharatiya Lok Dal, Socialist Party, Congress for Democracy, Chandra Shekhar Group (former congressmen) and others.
2.	1979–1980	Janata Party (Secular)	Charan Singh (Janata(S))	Janata (S) and Congress (U). Congress (I) supported from outside.
3.	1989–1990	National Front	V.P. Singh (Janata Dal)	Janata Dal, TDP, DMK, AGP and Congress (Socialist) BJP and Left parties supported from outside.
4.	1990–1991	Janata Dal (Socialist) or Samajwadi Janata Party	Chandra Shekhar (Janata Dal (S) or Samajwadi Janata Party)	Janata Dal (S) and Janata Party. Congress (I) supported from outside.
5.	1996–1997	United Front	H.D. Deve Gowda (Janata Dal)	Janata Dal, CPI, Congress (T), DMK, TDP, TMC, AGP, SP and others. Congress and CPM supported from outside.